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Social Connections and Recreation

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Loneliness is bad for your health

Being lonely cause the same amount of damage to your lifespan as smoking 15 cigarettes a day and is more dangerous to health than obesity. [1]

While a strong social support system improves overall outcomes and the ability to bounce back from stress. [3]

Women diagnosed with breast cancer who had weak social support systems before treatment had more pain and symptoms of depression over time than those who started treatment with strong social support systems. [4]



Social interaction and recreation are all around good for you

People with strong social relationships are 50% more likely to live longer. [5]

Taking a vacation can help you to feel happier and less stressed for a while. Even short vacations help! [7]

One study showed that people who participated in leisure activities like reading, playing board games, playing musical instruments, and dancing were less likely to develop dementia. [9]

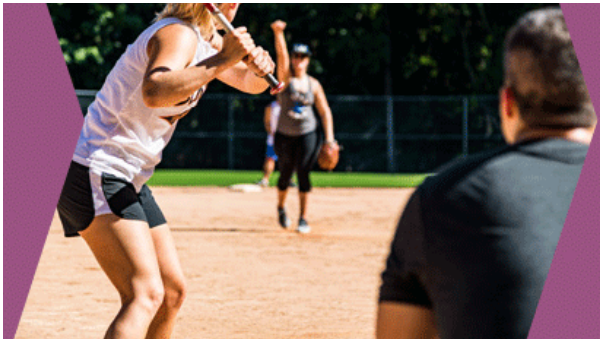
Considerations for caregivers



Feelings of loneliness and isolation are common among caregivers. [11]



Adult day care and other respite programs can help reduce the demands on caregivers which may improve morale and allow more time for social and recreational activities. [12]



football are pretty common. Depending upon where you live you may be able to find other games like bocce ball, skee ball, or shuffleboard as well.



Check [meetup.com](#). This website has groups all over the country that are based around specific activities or interest areas.

Volunteer! [Volunteermatch.org](#) has a database of opportunities across a variety of causes, nationwide



class.
Check
out
your
local
parks
and

recreation department or look at national chain stores like Michaels or Home Depot that offer classes and events.

Are you struggling?

If you are taking steps to care for your mind, body, and soul but still feel like you are struggling with your mental health, visit www.mhascreening.org to check your symptoms. It's free, confidential, and anonymous. Once you have your results, MHA will give you information and help you find tools and resources to feel better.

Sources

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